W.S.87. **Energy resources.** Name .....

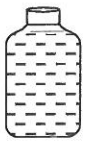
Most of the energy that we use to heat our homes and to power our machines comes from FOSSIL FUELS. These are coal, oil and natural gas. It takes millions of years for fossil fuels to form from the remains of dead plants and animals. We say that they are NON-RENEWABLE because once we have used them up we cannot replace them. In the future we will need to rely more upon RENEWABLE energy resources (those that will not run out).

Renewable energy resources.

Biofuels - from plants and animals.

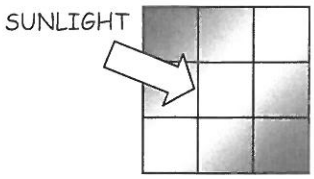


Wood can be burnt.



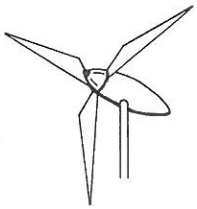
Alcohol can be made from plants and then used instead of petrol.

Solar power



Solar panels and solar cells capture the Sun's energy. It must be a sunny day.

Wind power



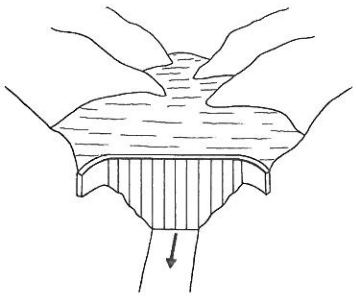
Sailing-boats use wind power to move them. Wind turbines are used to produce electrical energy. It needs windy weather.

Wave power



The movement of waves on the sea can be used to drive generators. This is expensive to set up.

Gravitational energy



Water is stored at a height in dams. As it rushes downhill gravitational energy is changed into moving energy. This can be used to turn turbines which produce electricity.

Exercise - Complete the sentences below.

1) Most of the energy we use comes from F _ _ _ _ _ fuels.

2) Fossil fuels are non-renewable because they cannot be R _ _ _ _ _ _ _

3) R _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ energy resources do not run out.

4) Biofuels come from P _ _ _ _ _ and animals.

5) Weather conditions must be suitable to use W _ _ _ and solar power.

6) The energy in waves can be used but it is E _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ to set up.

KS3 Science Revision Worksheets Special Edition © P. Hill, Beaver Educational Resources 2000. Registered to Fitzalan High School. CF11 8XB.